

Dairy Production

Land Sciences

May, 2026

Dairy Production (A11419)

Short Title: Dairy Production
Faculty Science and Computing
Department Land Sciences
Cluster Agriculture
Author JRYAN
Credits 5

Level: Introductory

Description of Module / Aims

This module will enable the student to manage a modern dairy enterprise, including the factors that influence milk quality and yield. The student will learn how to implement dairy herd feeding and management programmes, as well as disease control strategies. The student will also learn how to evaluate milking equipment.

Programmes

AGRI -0021 BSc in Agriculture (WD_SAGUL_D)

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Indicative Content

- Milk quality and yield
- Milking equipment and cleaning routines
- Dairy facilities
- Feeding and management
- Diseases
- Rearing replacements
- Economics of dairy production

Learning Outcomes

On successful completion of this module, a student will be able to:

1. State factors which influence milk quality and yield.
2. Review milking equipment and cleaning routines.
3. Compare dairy facilities.
4. Construct feeding and management programmes.
5. Plan disease control strategies.
6. Determine appropriate rearing methods for replacement heifers.
7. Examine the economics of milk production.

Learning and Teaching Methods

- Lectures.
- Practical instruction.

Assessment Methods

	Weighing	Outcomes Assessed
Final Written Examination	50%	1,3,4,6
Continuous Assessment	50%	
<i>Assignment</i>	50%	2,5,7

Assessment Criteria

<40%: Very limited knowledge and understanding of the subject matter.

40%-49%: Demonstrate a limited knowledge of the subject matter. May have some problems with critical thinking and problem-solving.

50%-59%: Demonstrate satisfactory general knowledge of the main issues within the subject. Good practical skills.

60%-69%: In addition, the student will demonstrate more detailed knowledge of the all topics, and demonstrate an ability to evaluate detailed knowledge acquired in the module to new material.

70%-100%: The learner will be able to demonstrate comprehensive knowledge and understanding of all learning outcomes, and an ability to evaluate and relate topics that overlap all of the learning outcomes.

Learning Modes

Learning Mode	F/T Hours	P/T Hours
Lecture	24	
Field Trips	24	
Independent Learning	87	

Essential Material

- Bell, P. *_Dairy Herd Management_*. Oakpark: Teagasc, 2001.

Supplementary Material

- Bell, P. *_Making Profits with Dairy Cows & Quotas_*. Oakpark: Diamond Farm Book, 1998.
- Chamberlain, A.T. *_Feeding Dairy Cows_*. London: Chalcombe, 1996.